

Barrier Breakers, March 20, 2026. Students from across Northeast Ohio before the first pitch of the morning.

Reach 8,000 students. Put the top 250 in one room.

Barrier Breakers is FinMango's one-day entrepreneurship competition for Northeast Ohio high schoolers, heading into its fourth year. In 2026 we promoted it to roughly **8,000 students in 25+ high schools** across the Akron, Canton, and Cleveland areas through our in-person classroom programming over the academic year. About **250 of the top students** from those classrooms showed up on March 20 to pitch real solutions to the costs that hold families back. Sponsors fund the prize pool and the day, and they meet those students face to face as judges. Levels and a commitment form are on pages 3 and 4.

~8,000

Students reached in person across 25+ high schools in the Akron, Canton, and Cleveland areas, where the event was promoted

~250

Top students from those classrooms who competed on event day

$20K+

Awarded in 2026 as cash to winning teams, grants to their schools, and scholarships

How the pipeline works

In the classroom. FinMango teaches in-person financial education in 25+ high schools across the Akron, Canton, and Cleveland areas, reaching about 8,000 students over the academic year. That is where students first hear about Barrier Breakers.

The build. Teams of one to three pick a real barrier, such as transportation, housing, healthcare, or financial literacy, and build a solution to bring to the event.

Event day. Sixty-second pitches to a three-judge panel in the morning. Five finalists present to the whole room at Demo Day in the afternoon, and the cash goes to the teams.

2026 at a glance

Event date	**March 20, 2026**
Students competing	**~250**
Presenting sponsor	**Valmark Financial Group · $25,000**
Silver sponsors	**2 · $2,500 each**
Awarded to students and schools	**$20,000+**
Demo Day finalists	**5 teams**
1st place award	**$7,500 cash, scholarship & school grant**

What a sponsor gets on the day

Our 2026 presenting sponsor was visible to every student in the building, from check-in through the awards. Every level puts your name in front of the students, and every level above Silver puts your people on the judging panel.

- Logo on the site, the printed program, and, at higher levels, every banner and student handout
- Your employees judge: sixty-second pitches at the tables, Demo Day for the top levels
- A table and banner on the gallery floor for the presenting sponsor
- Sponsor representatives present awards alongside the judging panel

Where the money went in 2026

Barrier Breakers 2026 raised $30,000 in total: $25,000 from the presenting sponsor and $5,000 from two Silver sponsors. More than $20,000 went out as awards. The rest paid for the day itself: breakfast and lunch for 250 students plus their teachers and judges, materials, and the space.

In 2026 a sizable share of the awards went to scholarships through the host university rather than to the students in the room. Scholarships will not come out of the sponsorship budget in 2027. Sponsor dollars go to the prizes and the event itself, managed directly by FinMango.

Presenting sponsor	**$25,000**
Two Silver sponsors	**$5,000**
Total raised	**$30,000**
Awards: team cash, school grants, scholarships	**$20,000+**
The day: food, materials, space	**Remainder**



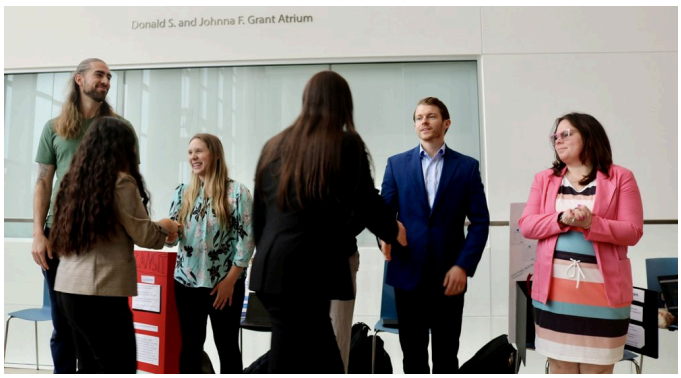
The presenting sponsor's table on the gallery floor, where students stopped between judging rounds.



The gallery round: sixty seconds to make the case, then questions from a judge.



Demo Day: five finalists present for five minutes each in front of every student in the room.



Awards: cash to the teams and a handshake from the judges, including the sponsors'.

Sponsoring Barrier Breakers 2027

The day keeps the same rhythm, a morning of pitches at the tables and Demo Day in the afternoon, with a simpler format for 2027: one pipeline for every team, no tracks to declare, one rubric for both rounds, and cash straight to the student teams. With no scholarship component, more of each sponsor dollar reaches the students in the room.

~$100

Per student in the room. What a $25,000 presenting sponsorship worked out to across the 250 students who competed in 2026

~$3

Per student reached, across the 8,000 who heard about Barrier Breakers in a FinMango classroom

25+

High schools in the Akron, Canton, and Cleveland areas where FinMango teaches in person. The 2027 invitation goes wider

How the $25,000 budget is planned

Prize pool: five Demo Day teams and honorable mentions	**$17,500**
The day: breakfast, lunch, materials	**$5,000**
Operations and contingency	**$2,500**
Total	**$25,000**

Approximate. Roughly seven of every ten dollars go to students as prizes.

What sponsorship funds

The prize pool. Cash to the five Demo Day teams, the largest share of the $20,000+ awarded in 2026.

The day. Breakfast, lunch, and materials for 250 students plus their teachers and judges.

Operations and contingency. Venue, AV, printing, insurance, and a reserve for the unexpected costs of an event this size.

FinMango is all-volunteer with no paid staff, so the full sponsorship is invested in the event: prizes first, then the day.

Sponsorship levels

Platinum · presenting sponsor — **$25,000**

"Powered by" naming across the event and the site. Stage time at the awards, a seat on the judging panel, logo on every banner, flyer, and student handout, and first call on the 2028 slot.

Gold — **$10,000**

Funds a Demo Day prize in your name. Logo on the site and event banners, a seat on the judging panel, and a mention from the stage at the awards.

Event Day Sponsor — **$5,000**

Covers the day itself: breakfast, lunch, and materials for 250 students plus their teachers and judges. Logo on the site and in the printed program, signage at the meals, and a seat on the judging panel.

Silver — **$2,500**

Logo on the site and in the printed program, and an invitation to judge.

Name a prize — **Any amount**

Fund 1st place or the honorable mentions, and we announce it that way at the awards.

Where 2027 stands

Date and host campus	**Spring 2027, announced with sponsors**
Judges	**Recruiting now, 15 needed**
Schools invited	**FinMango's 25+ and more**

Scott Glasgow, Founder & Executive Director, FinMango · competition@finmango.org · finmango.org/barrier-breakers

Levels are a starting point. A named prize, a sponsored lunch, or more of your team on the floor as judges can all be built around you.

Sponsorship commitment form

Check a level, fill in the details, and return this page to competition@finmango.org. We will confirm by email and send the logo specifications and judge invitation together.

Sponsorship level

- ☐ Platinum · $25,000
- ☐ Gold · $10,000
- ☐ Event Day Sponsor · $5,000
- ☐ Silver · $2,500
- ☐ Name a prize · $ _____

Sponsor details

Company or organization _____

Contact name and title _____

Email _____

Phone _____

Mailing address _____

Prize name, if applicable _____

Name as it should appear in recognition _____

Employees interested in judging _____

Authorized signature _____

Date _____

Payment. Make checks payable to FinMango and mail to FinMango, 1410 Gray Fox Drive, North Canton, OH 44720. FinMango is a 501(c)(3) public charity, EIN 81-2543425. A W-9 is available on request.

Recognition. Logos are due four weeks before the event for banners and the printed program. Send vector files (SVG, EPS, or PDF) to competition@finmango.org.

Contact. Scott Glasgow, Founder & Executive Director, FinMango · competition@finmango.org · finmango.org/barrier-breakers